

Northstar Works - Information Handling and Supplier Confidentiality Policy

Document LEG-DATA-07 | Edition 2.2 | Restricted synthetic demonstration

Owner: Legal Operations | Fictional approver: Information Governance Committee

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Fictional internal policy, not legal advice or a statement of applicable law.

1. Purpose and interpretation

1.1 This policy describes Northstar's fictional internal handling commitments for business records received from employees, customers and suppliers. Its controls support contract administration and information governance. Questions about applicable law or a specific agreement must be referred to the legal owner; a general policy extract must not be presented as legal advice.

1.2 Apply the more specific reviewed contract instruction when the information owner has confirmed that it governs the record. Do not infer an exception from an informal email. An unresolved conflict between instructions is recorded and escalated without discarding either source or selecting a convenient interpretation.

1.3 The classification owner is accountable for deciding the business need, access population and permitted handling location. A system administrator's ability to maintain a service does not grant automatic access to every business document stored in that service.

2. Classification and minimum access

Class | Example | Approved sharing pattern

Public | Released product brochure | Published approved copy

Internal | Team procedure without personal records | Company task-based access

Confidential | Supplier negotiation or employee case | Named team or explicit individuals

Restricted | Counsel correspondence or investigation material | Named matter team only

2.1 Classification is assigned at creation and reviewed when the content or audience changes. A document's title can itself reveal sensitive context, so restricted titles and metadata must not appear in a general catalogue. A request for access does not authorize displaying the restricted content while approval is pending.

2.2 Grant access for a defined purpose and population. Individual exceptions identify the owner and review trigger. Removing a team member requires reviewing their direct grants as well as role membership. Historical source inspection and downloads must use current permissions, not a snapshot from the day an answer was created.

2.3 Copies made for a task carry the same handling obligation. Sending a link is preferred to sending a new attachment because the link can apply current access. A source hash demonstrates content identity; it does not establish a right to access the source or make its contents public.

3. Supplier material and controlled disclosure

3.1 Record the agreement or matter reference before accepting restricted supplier material. The business owner confirms the intended audience and the handling location. The legal team checks obligations that differ from the standard process and records an approved instruction for the specific matter.

3.2 Before a disclosure, confirm the recipient, purpose, minimum content and approval. Do not

rely on an address copied from an old conversation when the recipient has changed organizations. Use an approved transfer channel and preserve the disclosure record with the matter reference.

3.3 If a supplier asks for a deletion, preservation or export action, pause routine handling and route the request to the legal owner. The team reconciles the request with relevant retention and preservation instructions. A support operator should not improvise a retention period from a number found in unrelated policy text.

4. Retention, preservation and corrections

4.1 The record owner assigns the approved record category and the applicable disposition rule from the controlled schedule. This document does not invent a universal duration. A matter preservation notice suspends routine disposal for its defined scope; release of that notice is a separately recorded decision.

4.2 Corrections preserve provenance. If a record contains inaccurate information, retain the correction reason and distinguish a corrected working copy from the original received evidence. Do not overwrite an uploaded source to make an earlier citation look correct; issue a new version and review its exact supporting span.

4.3 A disposition event records the scope, authorizer, execution result and exceptions. Failed deletion is not reported as complete. Backups and derived copies are considered through the approved schedule, with the information owner deciding any residual handling obligation.

5. Assurance and incidents

5.1 Owners review access after a team change, matter closure or reported handling concern. The review checks both role and named grants. Audit extracts contain the safe action, outcome, event time and request reference; they should not contain raw legal documents, passwords or personal case narratives.

5.2 Suspected misdelivery or unauthorized access follows the incident SOP and the legal escalation path. Preserve the original event evidence without broadening access. Communications use verified scope and clearly label what is not yet known. A lack of observed downloads is not proof that no disclosure occurred.

5.3 Edition 2.0 introduced classification; 2.1 clarified supplier transfers; 2.2 added metadata confidentiality and current-permission checks for historical citations. The source remains restricted to the fictional reviewer and auditor. Cortex can display it to authorized readers but does not answer arbitrary legal questions from unreviewed prose.